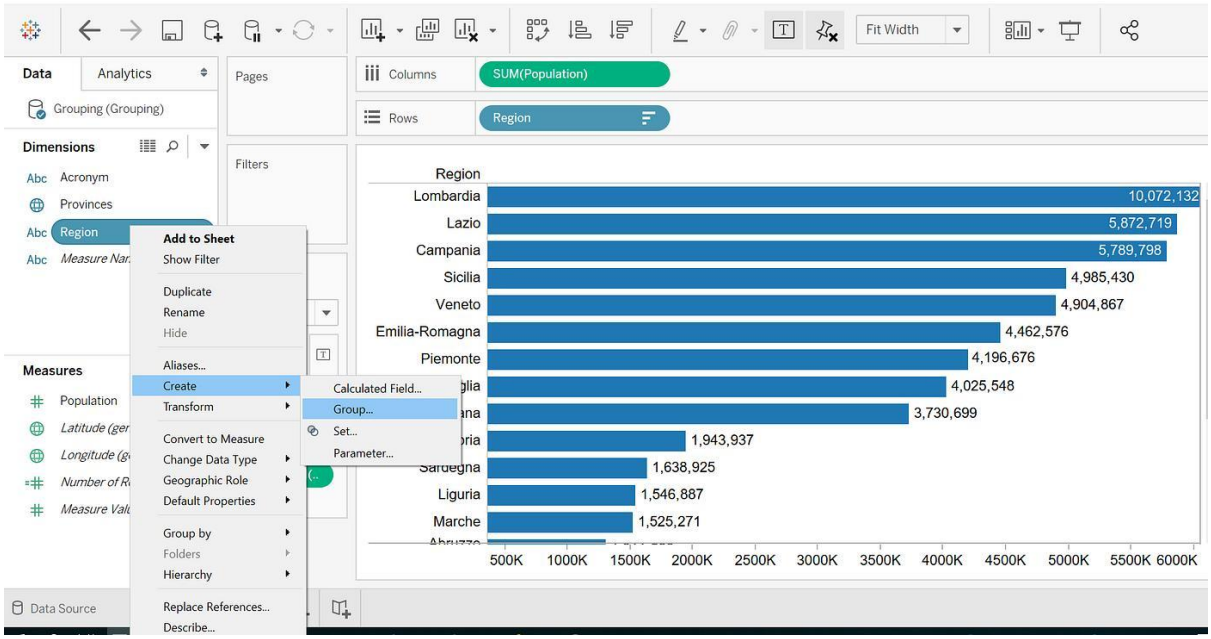
Difference between Groups and Sets in Tableau

Basis	Groups	Sets
Meaning	Combine multiple dimension members into one category.	Divide data into two parts: IN and OUT.
Purpose	To group similar values together.	To identify a specific subset of data.
Creation	Select members and group them manually.	Select members manually or define conditions.
Data categories	Combines selected members into a single group.	Separates selected members from the remaining data.
Example	Combine Lucknow, Kanpur, and Agra into “Uttar Pradesh Cities.”	Identify the Top 10 customers by sales.

1. Groups — Use case



Example: Suppose you have sales data for different cities.

You want to combine Lucknow, Kanpur, and Agra into one category called UP Cities.

Steps:

1. Right-click the City dimension.
2. Select Create → Group.
3. Select Lucknow, Kanpur, and Agra.

4. Click Group and rename the group to UP Cities.

Result: These cities will be treated as one category in your visualization.

When to use: When you want to combine similar values, such as cities into regions or products into categories.

2. Sets — Use case



Example: Suppose you want to identify the Top 10 customers by sales.

Steps:

1. Right-click the Customer Name dimension.
2. Select Create → Set.
3. Open the Top tab.
4. Select By field → Top 10 by SUM(Sales).
5. Click OK.

Result: Tableau identifies the top 10 customers as IN and the remaining customers as OUT.

When to use: When you want to analyze top-performing customers, high-sales products, or selected data against the remaining data.